

UPDATED: March 8th, 2026



PERCY JACKSONVERSE
BACKGROUND GUIDE

TRITONMUN XXXI – APRIL 12TH, 2026

MODEL UNITED NATIONS AT UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

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HEAD CHAIR LETTER

Hello Delegates,

It is my pleasure to welcome you to TritonMUN XXXI! My name is Sarah Atito, and I will be serving as your Chair for the Percy Jacksonverse committee alongside my Vice Chair Alex Sifuentes, and Deputy Crisis Director Anthony Lee.

I am a third-year student studying Cognitive Science and Data Science, with a passion for accessibility in education. In my free time I love exploring nature, reading and live music.

Much of my childhood was spent in libraries and reading. I especially loved fantasy and choose-your-own-adventure books. This committee in a way blends the two. Together, you and your fellow delegates will step into the universe Rick Riordan created, navigating challenges and beginning to shape the story as it unfolds.

I have been involved in Model UN for about 5 years, and have appreciated how it has led me to grow not only as a delegate but as a person. MUN has built my creativity, adaptability and collaborative skills, and I am looking forward to meeting you in committee and seeing how you evolve and tackle the crisis ahead!

All the best,

Sarah Atito

satito@ucsd.edu

CRISIS DIRECTOR LETTER

Hello Delegates,

My name is Anthony Lee, and I'll be your Deputy Crisis Director for this committee. I'm a second year pre-law molecular biology major from Warren College, and in my free time I like playing music and taking walks.

I remember reading *The Lightning Thief* for the first time when I was in fourth grade. The mix of stories of ancient gods and the adventures of heroes fascinated me, and I soon found myself finishing other works of Rick Riordan like *The Heroes of Olympus*, *The Kane Chronicles*, and when it eventually released, *Magnus Chase*. These books have helped build my love of long stories, which has inspired me to learn more both about fictional worlds and the real world.

I've always wondered what it would be like to be a hero who goes off on their own adventures, and that's why we wanted this committee. Sarah, Alex, and I have been hard at work so that our delegates can save the world as ancient heroes, and we look forward to seeing how you all will save it in committee.

Sincerely,

Anthony Lee

ajl030@ucsd.edu

VICE CHAIR LETTER

Hello Delegates,

My name is Alexander Sifuentes and I am delighted to be serving as your vice chair alongside Sarah and Anthony. I am a Second-year Political Science major with a concentration in Data Analytics. In my spare time I love keeping up with election news, raging at the latest Spurs defeat (COYS), and learning new songs on Guitar!

Throughout my MUN journey I have experienced and competed in many committees that allow delegates to be creative and allow fantasy sides to flourish. I've competed in a Pokémon crisis, a Christmas murder mystery committee, and even staffed a committee where all the delegates were Communist spies!

Serving as the Travel Director for UCSD's competitive MUN team, I hope to see delegates embody the spirit of MUN and forge their own adventures as I have seen across the circuit. I am excited for you all to explore the Riordanverse, and I hope you guys have as much fun as I do when competing!!

Sincerely,

Alexander Sifuentes

asifuentes@ucsd.edu

POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

TRITONMUN POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

- Position Papers are due on **April 3rd at 11:59pm.**
 - Requests for extensions must be sent by the advisor to TritonMUN by **March 22nd.**
- Position Papers must be submitted to the **Google Form** linked here:
 - <https://forms.gle/MYs4YcKAYDzqVRaJ9>
- Format.
 - Papers should be double-spaced in Times New Roman 12 pt. font and include no pictures.
 - At the top of each paper, include your country/person, name, committee, and topic.
 - Required* Sections: Each of these sections should be clearly labeled
 - Background
 - Past Actions by the Committee (if applicable)
 - Position of your Country/Person
 - Possible Solutions

*Some committees may ask for different formatting or an alternative to a position paper altogether, this will be clearly noted in the background guide for that committee

RULES OF PROCEDURE

This will be a **no-tech** committee, and as such use of laptops, phones, and other devices are strictly forbidden. All directives, JPDs, and backroom notes are to be handwritten on paper we will provide. Additionally, use of AI, whether for research or for writing directives, is strictly forbidden, and delegates caught using AI will be disqualified from awards.

The note-cycle will follow standard crisis procedure, with a two-notepad system and regular crisis updates.

Sponsor and Signatory requirements for directives and JPDs will be decided on the day of committee. Directives, JPDs, and backroom notes may only be written during committee sessions and may not be worked on during breaks. Unless specified otherwise, all Rules of Procedure follow the ROP guide posted on our website.

SENSITIVITY STATEMENT

We understand that our committee centers around religion, and that it is a sensitive topic. We ask that all delegates respect the religions and cultures of all civilizations, including those of modern and ancient civilizations, and including those of civilizations not mentioned in this background guide. We also acknowledge that many characters in the Percy Jackson universe have disabilities, some may have unstable family situations, and some may have inconsistent housing, and we ask delegates to respect this. Additionally, some characters in the Percy Jackson universe are members of the LGBTQ community, and we ask delegates to respect this.

Additionally, we are aware that certain parts of ancient mythology can be unpleasant, and we therefore ask that all delegates stick to Rick Riordan's rendition of ancient mythology when doing research. If a delegate has found information about ancient mythology that is both not mentioned by Rick Riordan and unpleasant, we ask that they think twice before sharing it with the committee.

DEI AND AI POLICIES

Sensitivity & Harassment Policy:

TritonMUN is committed to fostering a healthy environment for diplomacy and dialogue, and upholding standards of diversity, equity, and inclusion for all delegates. Harassment or disruptive behavior of any kind—whether verbal or non-verbal, in or out of committee—is strictly prohibited. All attendees and staffers should be treated with equal respect, and discrimination on the basis of race, color, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, nationality, ethnicity, or physical/mental disability will not be tolerated. This list is not exhaustive, and should not be treated as such. **Please report any instances of harassment to conference staff, either directly or through the Anonymous Feedback Form.**

In addition, we acknowledge that topics discussed in-committee may be politically sensitive, particularly in Specialized and Crisis Committees. While we understand that delegates may be immersed in the action and setting of their committee, delegates must maintain decorum and refrain from inflammatory language and actions, even when doing so may be historically accurate to one's character, group, or country. When drafting crisis directives, delegates should refrain from pursuing any action that explicitly violates human rights, including—but not limited to—enslavement and genocide. **Please refer to your committee's background guide for specific sensitivity statements and guidelines, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair.**

All attendants should observe these policies during the entirety of the conference, even outside formal debate, including opening/closing ceremonies, "FUNMUN", etc. Please note that violation of these policies may result in consequences such as disqualification from awards and contact towards the delegate's Advisor. At TritonMUN, our goal has always been focused on the delegate's abilities to enjoy and have fun in committee. However, in order to truly enjoy TritonMUN, delegates must feel safe in committee, which starts with respecting one another.

Plagiarism & Generative AI Policy:

TritonMUN recognizes that Model United Nations provides a space for aspiring leaders to showcase their work and abilities, and that all delegates wish to be evaluated in a fair and accurate manner. As such, we expect all delegates to perform with integrity and refrain from plagiarizing the work of their peers. This includes—but is not limited to—claiming the work of another delegate as one's own, including another bloc's unique clause without prior approval from the original writer, and replacing another's work with one's own (i.e. overwriting).

In addition, delegates are strictly prohibited from utilizing generative AI to produce position papers, resolutions, and directives, in part or in their entirety. Research conducted using generative AI risks AI hallucination, generating incorrect information and is strongly discouraged.

Resolution Work Outside of Committee:

TritonMUN wishes that all delegates use their breaks and downtime as intended: to connect, relax, and refresh. While not in committee, delegates are strictly prohibited from working on resolutions and directives. In addition, this means that pre-writing, or preparing resolutions and directives before the start of the conference, is strictly prohibited.

Technology Policy:

Delegates should expect the use of technology to be limited during committee sessions. Instead of having a universal technology policy for TritonMUN, such policies are individualized for each committee and set by their daises. Please refer to each committee's background guide to understand their technology policies, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair. Repercussive actions will be taken at the discretion of the head chair.

KEY TERMS

1. **The Mist:** A mystical force that prevents mortals from seeing gods, monsters, and other mythical beings.
 2. **Demi-gods:** Children who have one mortal parent and one godly parent, and possess the powers of their godly power.
 3. **Olympian:** One of the 12 ruling gods of the Greek pantheon.
 4. **Camp Half-Blood:** A summer camp that trains Greek demi-gods in using their powers. Located on the East Coast of the United States.
 5. **Thalia's Tree:** A tree that provides a magical barrier around Camp Half-Blood, preventing monsters of ill intent from entering.
 6. **Celestial Bronze:** A special type of metal that can kill monsters.
 7. **Mount Olympus:** The mountain on which the 12 Olympians rule the world. Has changed its location from Mount Olympus in Greece to the Empire State Building in New York.
 8. **Monsters:** Creatures from mythology who were distorted by the gods. Monsters reform in Tartarus when killed.
 9. **Tartarus:** A region in the underworld where monsters reform. Separated from the main part of the underworld
 10. **Quests:** Actions demi-gods take upon request of the gods. Usually done after a prophecy is given.
 11. **Oracles:** Mortals with the ability to see the future and see through the mist. Only one exists at the moment.
 12. **Drachma:** Golden coins used by gods and monsters as currency.
 13. **Nectar/Ambrosia:** The food and drink of the gods. Heals demi-gods upon consumption, but kills mortals and monsters if consumed.
 14. **Iris Rainbow:** A long-distance communication method used by gods and demi-gods. Creates a line of communication upon giving a drachma to a rainbow. Kind of like Zoom.
 15. **River Styx:** A river in the underworld. Making a promise on the River Styx creates a severe punishment for those who break it.
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PERCY JACKSONVERSE

Note: This does not take place in the standard Percy Jacksonverse timeline. This is a standalone story where all characters are coming together. If a delegate wants to get more familiar with the world of Percy Jackson, we would recommend watching the first season of the television show, or the first movie.

Generations grew up on the stories of the Ancient Gods, believing them to be nothing more than myth. However, many moons ago, crowds would worship and fear these deities, giving them strength in power. In the modern day, only a few know these stories are more than just bedtime tales, those who are the Half-Blooded children of the Gods, monsters, or the last believers. People have lost faith in the Greek Gods. With the population of those who used to worship and believe in them dwindling, the Gods are losing their power. Olympus is weakening and is fighting to have people believe in them again. The Gods, however, can not fully act on their free will as they can not break their rules, so they must act through their children, the demi-gods, to carry out their will.

As the Ancient Gods are already a shadow of themselves at their former power, their strongest source of strength are their ancient artifacts. Zeus has his lightning bolt, Poseidon wields his trident, and Hades his helm of darkness, which sustains them in times like these. While the gods are busy pointing fingers and complaining about their new weakened states, the minor gods grow unhappy with their mistreatment as their powers remain unaffected as they were used to little attention. To avoid a conflict between the gods and the devastation from the resulting war, the demi-gods must come together to find a peaceful resolution.

History of Greek Mythology/Ancient Greece

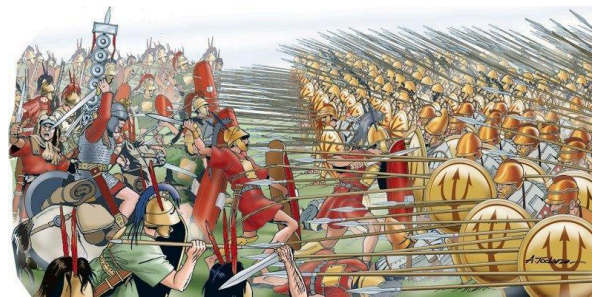
The civilization of Ancient Greece started out as a collection of small farming villages. Around this time, the people of Ancient Greece used gods to explain the things around them, and thus the gods were born. As the farming villages evolved into city-states, they grew more complex, with markets and governments being created. A side effect of the creation of city-states

was that other city-states could raise armies now, and to protect themselves, individual city-states dedicated themselves to a specific god, leading these gods to protect the cities.

While city-states were protected by the gods, the Ancient Greeks were still forced to expand outwards. Since the city-states had an agriculture-based economy but a finite amount of land, some people were forced to leave to find land to grow crops on. Additionally, while kings were removed, city-states were ruled by elites who refused to give common people political power, with some of these elites being descendents of the gods, encouraging many people to leave to gain rights. This caused the creation of colonies, city-states that came from, but were independent of, another city-state.



Unfortunately, the gods were not always capable of helping the Ancient Greeks in times of war. In one case, the Trojan War, the gods sided with different city-states, escalating the conflict from one between mortals only to one that also included the gods, making the destruction of the war greater. Additionally, when Rome was conquering Greece, they adopted a mythology closely resembling Greek mythology, preventing the Greek gods from having a military advantage on the Roman gods. With a centralized Roman Empire accepting new citizens, they gained power with each Greek city-state they conquered, while the individual Greek city-states could not successfully unite against the invading Romans.



Though conquered, the cities of Greece still survived, along with many aspects of their culture, including their language. However, the introduction of Roman mythology and, later, Christianity directly competed with Greek mythology for followers. In spite of the influence

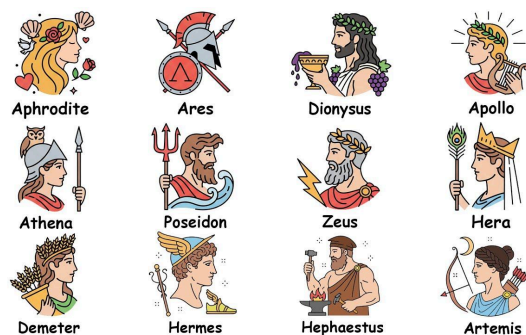
Greek culture had on Roman mythology and Christianity, Greek mythology could not withstand this competition, and Greek mythology slowly faded.

Greek Pantheon

Before the gods and men existed, there were two primordial beings, Gaia and Uranus. Gaia created the Earth, while Uranus created the sky. They had many children, including the twelve Titans. Eventually, Gaia and the Titans plotted to kill Uranus, and Kronos, the chief Titan, killed his father. But before his death, Uranus cursed Kronos to meet the same fate as he did. In time, Kronos had children of his own, but out of fear of being killed by them, consumed his children upon birth. His wife, Rhea, managed to hide her last child, Zeus, from Kronos. Zeus later returned and, pretending to be a servant, served Kronos poisoned wine, causing him to vomit out his other five children, the first gods. The gods, with alliances with other children of Uranus, managed to defeat the Titans, with many being thrown into the pit of Tartarus, and others being subject to other punishment.

With the Titans defeated, the Gods decided to rule over Earth. Zeus, the god of thunder and the skies, was named king of the gods, and he took the goddess Hera to be the queen of the gods and his wife. His brothers Poseidon and Hades took control of the sea and underworld, respectively, and were the most powerful gods aside from Zeus. Eventually, Zeus had children of

his own, and some became members of the twelve Olympians, the ruling council of the gods. While Hades refused to become an Olympian, gods and goddesses like Demeter, goddess of farming, and Ares, god of war, joined, increasing its strength.



At this time, humanity was far from flourishing. Seeing the need to bring technology to the humans, the

Titan Prometheus, who sided with the gods against the Titans and created the first humans, gave them fire against Zeus's orders, sparking rapid technological development but causing

Prometheus to be subject to grave punishment. Additionally, wanting to punish Prometheus's brother Epimetheus, Zeus gave a box full of the world's evils to Pandora, Epimetheus' wife, knowing that she'd open it and release evils onto the world. The technological advancement coupled with the temptations of evil would lead many humans to turn against the gods, with the gods turning some of them into monsters, for instance Athena turning the human Arachne into a spider after Arachne's pride and weaving skill humiliated the gods.

Additionally, some of the gods decided to have affairs with humans, giving rise to demi-gods, capable of using the power of the gods. Many demi-gods, like Hercules and Perseus, would slay the monsters the gods created. However, with the gods having affairs with mortals, sometimes their spouses or other gods grew jealous, with Athena turning Medusa into a monster after Posiedon had an affair with her in Athena's temple, and Hera killing all of Zeus' mistresses upon learning of their existence. The number of demi-gods and monsters both increased with the improvement of civilization.

The number of gods also grew during this time. Many Olympians decided to have more children, and minor gods like Eros were created. Additionally, some demi-gods were able to achieve immortality, with Hercules being promoted to a lesser god following his twelve trials, and Dionysus becoming an Olympian upon gaining a large following. However, in spite of the large number of minor gods, they don't have a major role in ruling the Earth, with Hercules being sent to guard an abandoned island, and other gods having no say in the affairs of Mount Olympus.

However, this is not the case for minor gods in the underworld. Due to the complex system of governance and large degree of independence from Mount Olympus, Hades finds many uses for minor gods. Thanatos, the god of death, is a key minor god that prevents the undead from leaving the underworld. In addition to employing many minor gods, Hades is known to employ both monsters and fallen humans. To get to the underworld, the ferryman Charon takes paying patrons across the river Styx, and for souls that make it there, they get judged



by the souls of three human judges. Once judged, a soul can be sent to the Fields of Punishment if they were evil, to the Fields of Asphodel if they were morally neutral, or to Elysium if they were good. The underworld also connects to Tartarus, though few residents of the underworld dare go there.

Camp Half-Blood and Demigods

Many Demigods grow up living normal human lives, unknowing that they are half Olympian. Most are teenagers when they find out about their true parentage and make the trek to Camp Half-Blood, the home, sanctuary, and training grounds for Demigods. In Camp Half-Blood, Demigods are housed in Cabins dedicated to their Olympian parent. There are 12 cabins in total, with a cabin for every Olympian, with Hades and minor gods being excluded. The demi-gods know who their godly parent is, and which cabin they belong to, when they are “claimed” by their godly parent, a ritual done during dinner time. Children of minor gods and Hades can not “claim” their children, as they have no cabins, and so all their children go to Cabin 11, Hermes Cabin. Percy Jackson, son of Poseidon, for instance is homed in Cabin 3, also known as the Poseidon Cabin, and is their lone resident. The cabins of the “Big Three”, along with Hera Cabin, have few residents as those gods do not have affairs with mortals. Many of the Demigods stay in camp until the end of their adolescence, completing quests for the gods.

While some demi-gods may make it to Camp Half-Blood on their own, the nature spirits known as Satyrs typically bring them to Camp Half-Blood, identifying them and protecting them on their journey to Camp Half-Blood. The lower part of a Satyr’s body is identical to that of a goat, so they typically use disguises to hide from mortals in addition to being hidden by the Mist. While Satyrs aren’t the strongest fighters out there, they are really good at detecting demi-gods and are friendly towards them, allowing them to convince demi-gods to come to Camp Half-Blood.

Once demi-gods make it to Camp Half-Blood, they begin training their fighting skills to survive monster attacks. While Camp Half-Blood is protected by Thalia’s Tree, which magically



keeps out monsters, the outside world is not and demi-gods frequently get attacked by monsters. Chiron, the activities director of Camp Half-Blood, trains demi-gods in using weapons, either personally or through large-scale combat situations. Demi-gods are provided with Celestial Bronze gear and weapons, since only Celestial Bronze (or other magical metals) can kill monsters, with the added benefit of Celestial Bronze being unable to harm mortals.

Usually, at least once a summer, demi-gods are sent on quests to serve the gods or to help out the camp. The Oracle of Delphi, a mortal gifted with the power of prophecy, periodically gets cryptic visions of the future, which indicate that the gods have a quest for demi-gods. What these prophecies mean are hard to understand when given, yet they provide recommendations for who to send on quests. Demi-gods only go on quests voluntarily and are given supplies before they head out. Quests are dangerous, and some demi-gods do not return alive.

Interactions with Mortals

While many mortals exist and some interact with the gods, most don't see them due to a mystical force called the Mist. The Mist gives gods, monsters, and mythical events rational explanations for mortals, and can hide them from view and create false memories if necessary. While the minor goddess Hecate made the mist after realizing the problems interactions between mortals and gods could have, they are unable to destroy the Mist, and even the Olympians were found to be unable to destroy it. However, the Mist can be manipulated by Gods and demi-gods skilled in magic, allowing Gods to show their true forms to mortals, and allowing demi-gods to create illusions.

The Mist was strengthened following World War 2, after the gods realized that their intervention in mortal affairs was causing too much damage. World War 2 was mainly a war between the children of Zeus and Poseidon on one side, and the children of Hades on the other, with other demi-gods and even gods taking sides in the war, causing massive damage. Seeing the damage they and their children were causing, the gods swore to never interact in mortal affairs again, and Zeus, Poseidon, and Hades, the "Big Three" gods, swore to never again have mortal children. All of them violated this pact at least once, and each has one surviving demi-god child.

While the gods don't interact with mortal affairs, they frequently form relations with mortals. Additionally, though most mortals are not able to see the gods, sometimes gods reveal themselves to mortals, especially when they are forming relationships with mortals. Seeing the gods allows those mortals to see through the Mist, though the gods do not have relations with mortals very often, leading only a few mortals to see through the Mist. Mortals that are able to see through the Mist are able to see monsters, and while monsters can kill mortals, mortals are unable to harm monsters as they lack the Celestial Bronze weaponry needed to do so. However, most monsters don't interact with mortals, and so mortals are generally unharmed by them.

Current Problems

With the weakening of the Olympians, the authority they wield has shrunk. This has caused monsters to act more boldly against demi-gods, since they know that the assistance the Olympians can give to their demi-gods children isn't as much as it was before. Additionally, minor gods are also more daring in challenging the gods, with Nemesis, the minor god of vengeance and balance, openly calling the Olympians unjust rulers, and Iris, the minor god of rainbows and messages, raising the cost of messages from the Olympians.

The weakening of the Olympians has many causes. For one, the expansion of consumer culture in the modern age has made people less interested in Greek mythology. With easily accessible and entertaining movies and games featuring characters like Mickey Mouse, Mario, and Iron Man gaining larger fan bases, Greek Mythology, largely unshown in popular culture, has been unable to keep up. Another reason for their weakening is the expansion of scientific knowledge. With individuals like Albert Einstein and Isaac Newton helping further understand the natural world, the need for Greek Gods to explain the unknown has faded.

Additionally, with individuals like Prometheus and Calypso still being punished, in spite of thousands of years and good behavior, many within the world of Ancient Greek beings have questioned the actions of the Olympians. Lesser gods are still excluded from decision-making, despite outnumbering the Olympians, and many are unhappy with their current status. Even among demi-gods, some are unhappy with their parents neglecting them, something Olympians do more compared to the lesser gods.

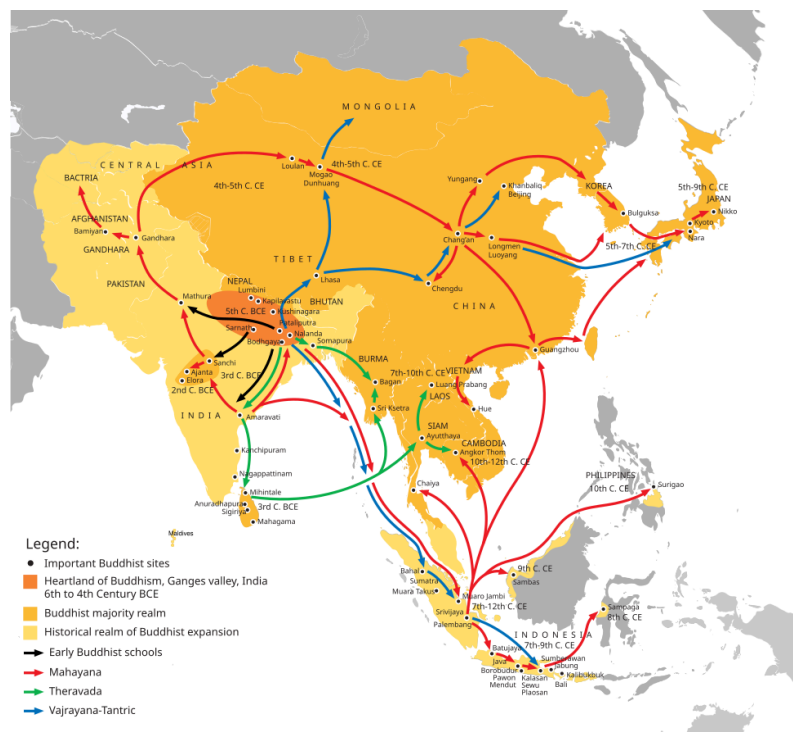
Case Studies

Culture and its aspects, including but not limited to religion, change over time. Whether a particular piece of culture survives or dies out depends on many factors: adaptability, popularity, and accessibility, to name a few. Here we show several cultures and how they adapted to stay afloat and even thrive in the modern era.

The Spread of Buddhism in East Asia

Originally from India, where the religion of Hinduism was deeply rooted, Buddhism had trouble spreading. Many tenets of Buddhism, like its denial of class-based religion, went against the beliefs of Hinduism, and struggled to gain a foothold there. Additionally, members of the ruling class, including the Brahmins endorsed by Hinduism, opposed Buddhism, denying Buddhists funding and ridiculing them. In order to survive, Buddhism had to find a more receptive audience abroad.

Buddhism, through merchants, eventually arrived in China, and adapted to the local culture in order to gain followers. Many Bodhisattvas, individuals who in the afterlife help others achieve inner peace, were given Chinese names, and certain Bodhisattvas came to represent material gain, helping it gain influence with the Chinese merchant class. Additionally, Buddhism took in ideas from Daoism, a prominent Chinese way of thinking, allowing the ideas of Buddhism to resonate with a Chinese audience. These adaptations made Buddhism immensely popular in China, and by the sixth century Buddhism was as popular as Daoism.



Buddhism also spread to Korea, though it faced initial opposition from the locals. While the Korean rulers adopted Buddhism as the official religion, thinking that it would legitimize their reign, local populations opposed it as they believed in local religions, with local elites in particular opposing Buddhism as the local religions legitimized their authority. To solve this issue and spread to local populations, Buddhism and local religions combined, with locals accepting the Buddha as yet another god, and Buddhists accepting local gods as protectors of the Buddha. This compromise between religions allowed Buddhism to gain prominence in Korea, and even today Buddhist temples contain shrines of other gods. Compromising on certain aspects of Buddhist religion allowed Buddhism to spread in spite of the existing belief system in Korea.

Eventually, the influence of its Chinese and Korean neighbors brought Buddhism to Japan. In spite of the deeply rooted Shinto religion, Buddhism spread due to its provision of new religious ideas. Shintoism did not have a clear conception of the afterlife nor a positive outlook towards death, so Buddhism, by having a positive outlook on dying, filled the niche left by Shintoism, causing Buddhism to spread without threatening Shintoism. Additionally, seeking to centralize power, the government found state-sponsored Buddhist temples a useful tool to increase state control of the populace, and this helped Buddhism spread. By expanding on previously untouched fields and by gaining governmental support, Buddhism expanded into Japan, even though it was unable to replace Shintoism.

While today Buddhism has spread far beyond the confines of Asia, its early experiences show how religions are able to spread. It shows how adapting to local cultures, compromising on certain beliefs, providing ideas on new subjects and seeking governmental support are all vital components of spreading religion.

Comebacks in the World of Music: Taylor Swift

Music artists can experience rough patches for a multitude of reasons beyond a natural decline in popularity and quality, and Taylor Swift is a prime example of this. Taylor Swift's career has experienced various ups and downs, with highs of being known as "America's

Sweetheart” to the lows of receiving media scrutiny and having public feuds, which would culminate in her taking a year-long hiatus from 2016-17. She came back from her hiatus with her 2017 album *Reputation*, which, like her previous albums, was released to critical acclaim by fans. For some time following, she had seemingly recovered from her public setback until the very public battle between Big Machine Records after her contract had expired.

Taylor Swift recorded her first 6 albums with Big Machine Records. Contract disputes meant that she wouldn’t keep any of the Masters (the original recordings) of her first 6 albums. Negotiations between businessman Scooter Braun and Big Machine Records would see the original masters sold to Braun, at the detriment of Taylor, who was never given an opportunity to purchase her own music. This lack of ownership would see her unable to perform most of her older catalog and even use her own music on her Netflix documentary, which was released in 2020. This publicized battle between Taylor Swift and Scooter Braun over ownership made known disputes that were all too common between artists and their music between record labels, who would write contracts that kept ownership mostly within the record companies as opposed to the artists.

While Braun held the rights to the original Masters of Taylor’s music, Swift still held the publishing rights (right to the melodies and lyrics), which meant she could simply re-record her old albums and own the new versions. She would do this with her first 4 albums, labeling them as “Taylor’s Version” to critical acclaim, which saw her viewed more as a media sweetheart and reach popularity similar, if not better, to what she received in the early 2010s. Furthermore, her “Eras Tour” in 2023, which sought to explore the various eras of her career, created memorable and immersive fan experiences while launching her into true legend status and cementing her legacy as one of the greatest singer/songwriters in the 21st century.

Taylor’s Comeback should prove to delegates that a comeback can include taking on an “us vs them” mentality since people like to root for underdogs. Similarly, rebrandings can help revitalize the image of gods who may have fallen into irrelevance.

CHARACTER PROFILES

Chiron, Director of Camp Half-Blood:

With the upper body of a man and the lower body of a horse, Chiron is the centaur Director of Camp Half-Blood. He acts as the mentor to generations of heroes who pass through the camp, and has dedicated his immortal life to training demigods for the dangers of the mortal and supernatural world alike. Despite being the son of the Titan Kronos, Chiron defied the tyranny his father held, and instead chose to guide heroes who can go against him. He is skilled in archery, medicine, and music, and is determined to use these skills to raise the next generation of heroes.



King Tantalus, Assistant Director of Camp Half-Blood:



A former demi-god and king from the times of Ancient Greece, King Tantalus angered the gods and was punished severely in the afterlife, cursed to be unable to consume food or drink water. However, to allow him to make amends for their misdeeds, King Tantalus was let out of the underworld to assist Chiron with running Camp Half-Blood. While grateful for being let out of the underworld, King Tantalus thinks that the gods are too cruel, and believes that changes

in the way the Olympians govern are necessary for the survival of the Greek Pantheon. Even though they lost their powers as a demi-god upon dying, King Tantalus has a thorough understanding of economics, governance, and management from his time as a king, and is determined to use this knowledge to aid Camp Half-Blood however he can.

Quintus, Swordmaster of Camp Half-Blood:

Formerly known as Daedalus, Quintus was the famed architect of The Labyrinth, a maze built to trap the Minotaur. However, he was trapped in The Labyrinth by King Minos after it was finished, and his son Icarus died when they tried to escape through the air. Knowing that King Minos, his enemy, became a judge of the dead and knowing that he murdered his nephew in a fit of jealousy, Quintus used his nephew's research to transfer his consciousness to a mechanical body, allowing him to escape



death and punishment for thousands of years. Believing King Minos to be a cruel person unfit to be a judge, and having made plenty of contraptions without the help of the gods, Quintus believes the Gods to be unnecessary and harmful for all of humanity, and has arrived at Camp Half-Blood to teach demi-gods how to survive without the aid of gods. With decades of combat experience with a variety of weapons and plenty of engineering knowledge, along with a pet hellhound, Quintus is prepared to raise the next generation of demi-gods.

Alecto, the Fury:

The most trusted servant of Hades, Alecto has spent thousands of years helping him run the Underworld. While indifferent towards the Olympians, Alecto is fiercely loyal towards Hades and believes that saving him is the most important task at hand. While not initially loyal to Camp Half-Blood, Hades has ordered her to go there to protect the demi-gods and teach them math as a sign of goodwill to the Olympians. With the power to shapeshift and fly, the assistance of her two sisters, and intricate knowledge of mortal and godly legal systems, Alecto will see her master's wishes through.



Grover Underwood, Satyr of Pan:



With the hooves and ears of a goat, Grover Underwood is loyal to Percy Jackson and took the satyr oath to protect demigods on their journeys safely. Deeply connected to nature, Grover carries a set of reed pipes around his neck through which he channels his woodland magic, allowing him to influence the growth of plants and draw strength from the wild. With a natural sense of the natural world, he can communicate with animals and form empathy links which allows him to share emotions and communication with the people he bonds with. He is devoted to the mission of his ancestors, the search of the lost god Pan, the Greek god of the wild, nature, and satyrs. Beyond his care for protecting Olympus, he is also passionate about protecting both nature and demigods, and will use their connections with other satyrs to defend them to the best of his ability.

Thalia Grace, Daughter of Zeus:

A powerful demi-god that can control the lightning, Thalia was at one point a target of monsters and was forced to flee to Camp Half-Blood for safety. Though she was mortally wounded upon arriving at Camp Half-Blood and turned into a tree by Zeus to save her life, she was eventually able to be reborn after the Golden Fleece was recovered and placed on her tree. Grateful to the gods for saving her life, Thalia is unconditionally loyal to the Olympians and will use her immense power over lightning to defeat all who oppose the gods.



Percy Jackson, Son of Poseidon:



Named after the Greek hero Perseus, and raised by his single mother Sally Jackson, Percy Jackson is the forbidden son of Poseidon, one of the Big Three Greek gods who promised to no longer have children with mortals. Because of this, Percy's existence defies a promise made by the gods, making him the target of many monsters and other forces greater than himself. He is gifted with the ability to control water, marine life, and influence weather. His powers grow stronger as he nears the sea. Much like his friends, Annabeth and Grover, he is fiercely loyal, however he often acts impulsively. As the son of the god of the sea, and half-brother to Cyclops Tyson, Percy is the physical symbol of a broken oath and also the potential turning point of Olympus. With a deep loyalty to Olympus and his friends at Camp

Half-Blood, he will make sure that the changes coming to Olympus will be positive changes.

Nico di Angelo, Son of Hades:

Once a twin, Nico di Angelo is now the last surviving son of Hades. Seeing the death of both his mother and his sister as the fault of the Olympians, Nico di Angelo resents and distrusts them, only going to Camp Half-Blood upon his father Hades' insistence. Welcoming the demise of the Olympians, but wanting to preserve his father's influence, Nico is determined to find a way to save Hades without saving any of the Olympians. With the power to control the earth, travel through shadows, and summon and converse with spirits, Nico will do all they can to cement Hades' control.



Annabeth Chase, Daughter of Athena:



As the daughter of Athena, goddess of battle strategy and wisdom, Annabeth Chase spent her life working to live up to her mother's reputation. She is known for her intelligence, strategy and architectural skills. Gifted with a nearly photographic memory and talent for architecture and design, she is someone people turn to when there is a problem to be solved. Annabeth appreciates approaching things with logic and preparation above all else. She is fiercely loyal to her friends, primarily Percy and Grover, and is determined to honor her mother's legacy. Beyond the power of her intellect, Annabeth is especially skilled at close combat, and with the support of her siblings in Athena Cabin, Annabeth is determined to protect Camp Half-Blood.

Luke Castellan, Son of Hermes:

As the son of Hermes, god of travelers and thieves, Luke Castellan possesses a talent for sleight of hand, reflexes, and enhanced strength. As a swordsman, he wields the Backbiter, a blade able to attack both mortals and immortals, and gives him the ability to disappear through ripples in the air. He also has a natural ease with alchemy and potions making. He is clever as well as skilled at combat, and has gained the respect of his siblings in Hermes Cabin. Once having fled to Camp Half-Blood with Thalia and Annabeth, Luke feels a brotherly affection for them, looking after them as a chosen family. However, his actions may not always align with their beliefs, as he has long felt neglected by the Olympians as the lives they lead are so distant from one another, and he is determined to create a new path for himself.



Silena Beauregard, Daughter of Aphrodite:

A daughter of Aphrodite and the head of the Aphrodite cabin, Silena Beauregard is skilled at socializing and has the respect of many other demi-gods. Having interacted with the other demi-gods at Camp Half-Blood, Silena views the other gods as extended family and is determined to prevent all conflicts between the gods. With control over persuasion, illusion, and love magic, along with skill in pegasus riding and help from their siblings in the Aphrodite cabin, Silena is determined to keep the peace between the gods.



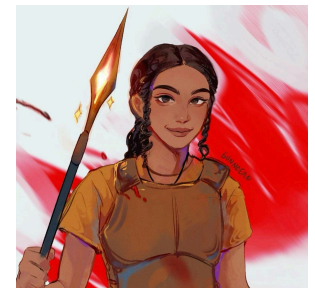
Katie Gardner, Daughter of Demeter:

A daughter of Demeter and head of the Demeter cabin at Camp Half-Blood, Katie Gardner has grown to have a deep respect for plants and agriculture. Acknowledging that farmers provide sustenance for humans, Katie believes that she should be alleviating the hunger of the world as a daughter of Demeter, and believes that gods do the same. While believing that gods who help out humans, like Demeter the goddess of farming, should be saved, she believes that gods who cause humans to suffer, like Ares the god of war, should not. With the support of her siblings in the Demeter cabin, Katie Gardner is determined to use her knowledge and control over plants to save the gods that will help humanity.



Clarisse La Rue, Daughter of Ares:

As the daughter of Ares, the god of war, Clarisse La Rue shares his fierce skill and temper, initially coming off as a bully to some of the demigods in Camp Half-Blood. She is constantly battling her pride as she feels the pressure to live up to her father's approval. Beneath her aggression lies a formidable bravery, wielding the skill of a warrior with



enhanced agility and speed. Those who earn her respect also earn her loyalty. The throws of battle do not make her waver, in fact it is where she is best suited as she dives into danger without hesitation. She wields the Maimer, an electric spear gifted to her by her father. While pride can guide her actions, her sheer strength and combat ability, along with her unshakeable loyalty to the Olympians and the support of her siblings in Ares Cabin, make her one of Camp Half-Blood's strongest defenders.

Charles Beckendorf, Son of Hephaestus:

A son of Hephaestus and the head of the Hephaestus cabin, Beckendorf is skilled in making machines. Seeing technology as something that can improve the lives of others, and acknowledging that the gods tried to keep the secret of fire from humanity, Beckendorf has no particular loyalty to the gods, though they are immensely loyal to Camp Half-Blood. With the skills to make machines, the aid of his siblings in the Hephaestus cabin, and access to the camp's forge and Celestial Bronze supply, Beckendorf is determined to protect Camp Half-Blood.



Will Solace, Son of Apollo:

A son of Apollo and the head of the Apollo cabin, Will Solace appreciates the finer things in life. Mostly skilled in medicine, despite Apollo also being the god of archery and music, Will wants to use his power to help others, and believes that the gods are key to helping humanity. With an expansive knowledge of medicine and powerful healing ability, along with the help of their siblings in the Apollo cabin who are skilled in archery and music, Will is determined to save the gods to better humanity.



Zoë Nightshade, Hunter of Artemis:

Before becoming a hunter, Zoë Nightshade, a daughter of Atlas, once helped out the hero Hercules on a quest to steal the golden apples her family guarded, but was ultimately discarded by Hercules and exiled from her family. Finding a new family with the Hunters of Artemis, the immortal legion of female hunters that help Artemis hunt monsters, Zoë found a new purpose in defeating the enemies of the gods. While distrustful of demi-gods and only loyal to Artemis, Zoë is willing to collaborate with others in order to save Olympus. With great skill in hunting and the aid of the Hunters of Artemis, Zoë is determined to save both Olympus and her friend Artemis.



Rachel Elizabeth Dare, Oracle of Delphi:

A mortal able to see through the mist and see into the future, Rachel Elizabeth Dare encountered the hidden world of Greek mythology by chance. Being the daughter of a wealthy businessman who destroys nature, Rachel feels responsible for the nature god Pan, and also is grateful towards Apollo for giving her the ability to see into the future, but aside from that has no loyalty to the gods. In spite of that, Rachel is deeply loyal to Camp Half-Blood for the community it provides. With visions of the future along with immunity to magic and Celestial Bronze weapons, along with the vast fortune her father has, Rachel is determined to protect Camp Half-Blood.



Ethan Nakamura, Son of Nemesis:

The son of a minor god, Ethan Nakamura is bitter about the unfair treatment of both him and his mother Nemesis. The son of the goddess of revenge and balance, Ethan believes that if the Olympians do not learn to respect minor gods, then the demise of the Olympians is a fair outcome. With loads of combat experience and the ability to manipulate luck, along with the assistance of other children of Nemesis left unclaimed in the Hermes cabin, Ethan is determined to fight for the equality of major and minor gods.



Paolo Montes, Son of Hebe:

The son of the goddess of youth, Paolo Montes values freedom above all else. Even though Hebe has no cabin in Camp Half-Blood due to being a minor goddess, Paolo holds no grudges against the Olympians since they allow the demi-gods to freely make decisions. Paolo is indifferent towards the gods, but is loyal to Camp Half-Blood for the opportunities they provide him. With the power of swift regeneration, along with the aid of other children of Hebe, Paolo is determined to protect Camp Half-Blood.



Alabaster C. Torrington, Son of Hecate:

The son of a minor god, Alabaster C. Torrington is bitter at the Olympians' unfair treatment of minor gods. A meticulous planner and devout student of magic, in addition to being the most powerful child of Hecate, Alabaster believes that even gods can be overthrown with the right preparation. Alabaster welcomes the destruction of the Olympians, and has no strong loyalty to Camp Half-Blood. With knowledge of all fields of magic and the ability to control the mist, along with skilled swordsmanship and the legendary Dr. Claymore serving as his personal assistant, Alabaster will do all they can to hasten the demise of the Olympians.



Butch Walker, Son of Iris:

The son of the goddess of rainbows, Butch Walker acknowledges that his mother doesn't get the respect she deserves, but still makes a lot of money from the Olympians. Butch is fiercely loyal to his mother, and though he tolerates the Olympians, he hopes that they one day learn to respect the gods. Additionally, Butch is tolerant of the other demi-gods at Camp Half-Blood, since they make sure to pay his mother for her services, though he has no strong loyalty to them. With the ability to travel through rainbows, along with skill in pegasus riding and the assistance from other children of Iris, Butch Walker is determined to get his mother the respect she deserves.



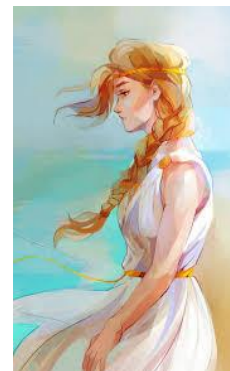
Tyson, the Cyclops:



Half brother of Percy Jackson and son of Poseidon, Tyson spent much of his childhood surviving on the streets of New York, until he found his way to Camp Half-Blood and learned of his true parentage. As a cyclops and a son to one of the Big Three Gods, he wields immense physical strength, beyond the typical demigod, and the ability to mimic voices. Despite his tall stature, Tyson can be easily overlooked because of his kind and gentle nature. However, he is extremely loyal to those close to him and will fight for them with little hesitation. Tyson also has a natural engineering talent, and is skilled at fixing mechanical problems. While many Demi-gods' feelings of their Olympian parents are complex and nuanced, Tyson does not hold any ill will towards Poseidon despite living a difficult childhood. He is prideful simply knowing he is the son of Poseidon, and is determined to help save his father.

Calypso, the Lonely Sorcerer:

A daughter of Atlas who once fought the gods, Calypso was sentenced to an eternity of solitude on the island of Ogygia as punishment. As part of her punishment, demi-gods occasionally arrive at the island and stay long enough for Calypso to fall in love, but then leave and break her heart. Out of pity, the gods created invisible servants for her, who can freely travel throughout the world and bring her news, in addition to doing tasks for her. Acknowledging both the cruelty of her punishment and the pity of the gods, Calypso holds no ill will towards the Olympians, but believes that the Olympians are too cruel and need to reform themselves in order to survive. Additionally, after only conversing with demi-gods over the past few thousand years, Calypso cares deeply about them,



and is determined to protect Camp Half-Blood despite never having been there. While unable to leave her island, Calypso is a powerful sorcerer whose magic can be felt across the world, and by staying in touch with the world through her servants and Iris messages, Calypso is more than capable of protecting the demi-gods of Camp Half-Blood.



QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

1. What's the best way to spread a belief system?
2. Are changes necessary to help Greek Myths stay alive in the current day? If so, what are they?
3. What actions can be taken to make an aspect of culture more popular?
4. What can demi-gods do to help increase the appeal of Greek Mythology?
5. What concessions do the major gods of Greek Mythology have to make to the minor gods?
6. Are changes to the Olympians' way of ruling necessary for their continued support and survival?

CLOSING REMARKS

While the Greek gods have overcome trials and tribulations in the past, the weakening of major gods is something outside of their control. The cruelty of the major gods, their neglect of minor gods, and the role of demi-gods must all be re-examined in light of the current situation. Whether or not the major gods are saved depends on the demi-gods of Camp Half-Blood, but whether they should be saved is something the demi-gods will ask themselves throughout their time there.

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